

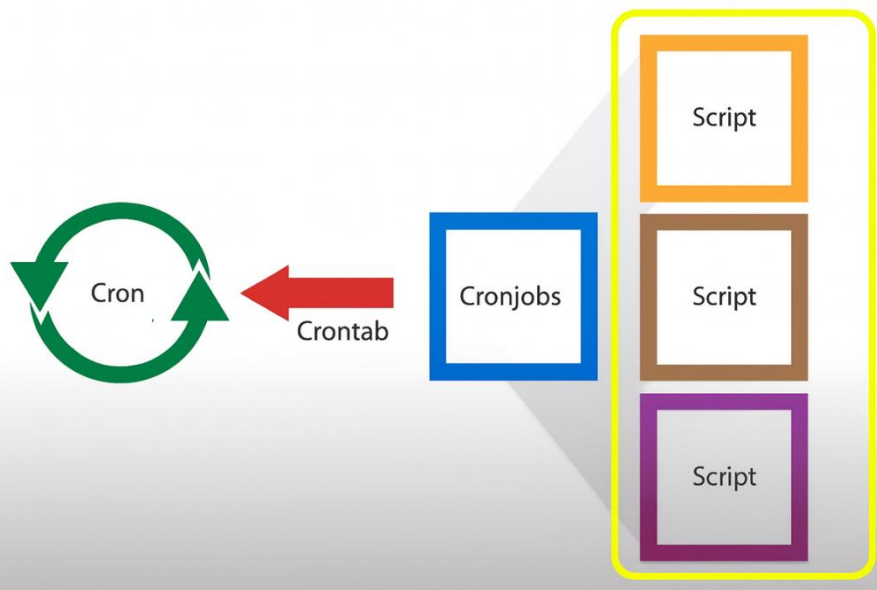
Automating the program

CRON DAEMON

- ❑ Scheduling regular maintenance tasks, such as backups, is managed by the cron service by a cron daemon (crond). A daemon is a continually running server that constantly checks for certain actions to take.
- ❑ These tasks are listed in the crontab file. The cron daemon constantly checks the user's crontab file to see if it is time to take these actions. It performs the specified operations at the predefined time when a certain event or condition is triggered without the intervention of a user
- ❑ Any user can set up a crontab file of his/her own. It is per user based.
- ❑ The root user can set up a crontab file to take system administrative actions, such as backing up files at a certain time each week or month.

- ⇒ Here daemon is a process continuously running in a server for checking continuous actions to take
- ⇒ Cron jobs are the jobs that will specify the scripts

CRON DAEMON



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CRON TAB

The crontab (abbreviation for "cron table") is list of commands to execute the scheduled task specific time

A cron tab entry in the crontab file has six fields.



The following example backs up the projects directory at 2:00 A.M. every weekday:

```
# Weekday backup for Alex's projects
```

```
0 2 * * 1-5 tar cvf backup.tar /home/projects
```

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CRON EDIT

\$crontab -e

(This will update the users cron file under /var/spool/cron directory)

Enter the crontab command to run the job (test.sh) for every 10 min

\$crontab -l

This prints the contents of your crontab entry

Note:

In case of Fedora, the cron service needs to be installed if not present

\$dnf install cronie

ANACRON

- ⇒ anacron is another utility, that is used to execute commands periodically with a frequency specified in days.
- ⇒ This will check the jobs need to be performed when the system is turned on again, after shut down
- ⇒ The anacron jobs, are placed as crontab entries in the /etc/anacrontab file.
- ⇒ anacron first checks for timestamp of the job then decides whether to run it or not and if its timestamp is $\geq n$ (n is defined number of days) then runs it after a specified time delay.